



Samah: Interview best practices

My name is Samah Moid, and I'm a recruiter here at Google for the large customer sales team. Basically, I hire talent for the sales team here. Even within the sales recruiting space, I recruit specifically for the analytical lead roles here at Google. I want the candidate to be as comfortable as possible. As a recruiter I'm also their advocate. If they're a good fit for the team, I'd like to present them in the best light. As a recruiter some advice I would give for a data analyst that's starting to look for a job. Think about a time where you've used data to solve a problem, whether it's in your professional or personal projects. Another tip, I would say for a data analyst that's looking for a new job is to increase your professional network. There are many ways to increase your professional network. One of them is to increase your online footprint,

reach out to other analysts on LinkedIn,
join local meet-ups with other data scientists.
Sometimes when we're looking for a unique skill set,
recruiters are going on websites like LinkedIn,
and GitHub, and trying to find that talent themselves.

It's really important to have your LinkedIn
updated along with websites like GitHub,
where you can showcase a lot of
the data analysts projects you've done.

Another tip I would say for
an in-person interview is to
prepare questions for the interviewer.

Make sure they're not broad questions.
They should be questions that will help you understand
the team and the job better.

If you're given a case study in an interview,
you should expect to be given
a business problem along with the sample data set.

Then you'd be asked to take that sample data set,
analyze it, and come up with a solution.

One of the things you can do to help prepare yourself for
this is to ensure
you are analyzing the data
and coming up with a solution
that relates back to that data.

Sometimes there is no right answer,

and a lot of times interviewers are looking to see
your thought process and the way
you get to your solution.

I highly encourage that if you
find a role that you're interested in,
not only apply to it, but go the next step.

Look for the recruiter. Look for
the hiring manager online.

See if you can reach out to them and set up
a coffee chat or send them your resume directly.

Online applications could be
a really big black hole where
you never hear back from the recruiter or the team.

When you reach out directly to
a hiring manager or recruiter,
it really shows your **eagerness**
for the role and your interests for the role.

Even if sometimes you don't
get a response from reaching out,
you never know, you try multiple different times.

That one time you get a response
back from a recruiter or hiring manager,
could be the time you get the job that you really wanted.